

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner for data platforms, airline domain.*

Positioning, Data-platform product owner with 13 years of cross-functional delivery, now targeting airline-domain data initiatives in Abu Dhabi.

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Dear Hiring Team at HTC Global Services,

I am writing to express my interest in the Product Owner (Data) contract role you have posted for the airline domain in Abu Dhabi. Abu Dhabi is one of my actively targeted locations, so this is not a compromise on either side: I am ready to relocate and work fully on-site.

The core of what you are looking for, a Product Owner who owns the backlog end-to-end, translates business requirements into user stories and acceptance criteria, and keeps engineering, QA, architecture, and business stakeholders moving in the same direction through tight Scrum cadences, is precisely the work I have been doing for over a decade. At Rohde & Schwarz I drove a cross-functional team of 15 engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence on an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme: I ran Sprint Planning, Sprint Reviews, and backlog refinement every fortnight, and I kept the release cadence honest by instrumenting competing delivery approaches and redirecting strategy when the data said to. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform from backlog to deployment: I introduced Dagster and dbt to eliminate manual data update effort and carried a full ETL migration and UI relaunch through the same sprint cycle without stalling the team.

What makes data projects hard is rarely the technology. It is the gap between what business stakeholders ask for and what data engineers can actually build in a sprint, and it widens every time a story lands in refinement with vague acceptance criteria. I close that gap by treating stakeholder interviews as product discovery, writing acceptance criteria before I write the story title, and running UAT coordination as a product responsibility rather than a QA handoff. At CLINET Platforms I cut a five-person team's roadmap to its highest-value 10% against agreed success measures, and user acceptance rose more than fivefold as a direct result.

I have 8 years of experience working with data-intensive systems in regulated and mission-critical environments, and 13 years of hands-on backlog ownership across insurance, healthcare, public-sector analytics, and defence. I work comfortably in fully Agile and SAFe setups, I know Jira and Confluence as daily instruments rather than reporting tools, and I carry enough technical depth in Python, SQL, ETL pipelines, and containerised environments to hold a meaningful conversation with a data engineer without asking them to slow down.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background maps to the airline-domain data initiatives HTC is delivering for its Abu Dhabi client. Please find my CV attached.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
